“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 8

The Reduction of the Meals

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. This chapter tells the story of Rāmacandra Purī. He was a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, but through association with the community of dry speculators (*śuṣka-jñānīs*) he took up their corrupt conclusions and began to teach what is contrary to dharma. For this Purī Gosāñi rejected him, calling him an “offender.” From then on Rāmacandra Purī blamed others, hunted for their faults and taught dry knowledge, and for all this the Vaiṣṇavas came to shun him. Later he blamed even the way Mahāprabhu ate. Mahāprabhu saw in him a relation to His own guru, so He said nothing to him; He only silently reduced His own food, the prasāda. When Rāmacandra Purī left Puruṣottama, the Lord gave up this reduction.

Obeisances to the Lord, who out of fear of Rāmacandra Purī reduced His meals —

তং বন্দে কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যং রামচন্দ্রপুরীভয়াৎ ।
লৌকিকাহারতঃ স্বং যো ভিক্ষান্নং সমকোচয়ৎ ॥ ১ ॥

taṁ vande kṛṣṇa-caitanyaṁ
Him I worship Kṛṣṇa Caitanya
rāmacandra-purī-bhayāt
of Rāmacandra Purī out of fear
laukikāhārataḥ svaṁ yo
than the ordinary food His own who
bhikṣānnaṁ samakocayat
alms-food reduced

1 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who, out of fear of Rāmacandra Purī, reduced His own meals below the ordinary measure.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I offer obeisances to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who out of fear of Rāmacandra Purī reduced His meals below the ordinary daily amount.

Anubhāṣya.
yaḥ (Kṛṣṇa Caitanyadeva) **rāmacandra-purī-bhayāt** (because He displayed worldly apprehension caused by the words of Rāmacandra Purī, a blasphemer of Hari, guru and the Vaiṣṇavas) **laukikāhārataḥ** (compared with the measure of food that people consider ordinary) **svam** (His own) **bhikṣānnam** (measure of food, although it was already moderate) **samakocayat** (reduced), **taṁ kṛṣṇa-caitanyam** (**aham**) **vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য করুণাসিন্ধু-অবতার ।
ব্রহ্মা-শিবাদিক ভজে চরণ যাঁহার ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya karuṇā-sindhu-avatāra
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya of mercy the ocean the descent
brahmā-śivādika bhaje caraṇa yāṁhāra
Brahmā, Śiva and the rest worship the feet whose

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya, the descent of the ocean of mercy, whose feet Brahmā, Śiva and the other gods worship!

জয় জয় শ্রীবাসাদি যত ভক্তগণ ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য প্রভু — যাঁর প্রাণধন ॥ ৩ ॥

jaya jaya śrīvāsādi yata bhakta-gaṇa
glory glory to Śrīvāsa and the rest all the devotees
śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya prabhu — yāṁra prāṇa-dhana
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the Lord whose of life the treasure

3 Glory, glory to Śrīvāsa and to all the devotees, whose life's treasure is the Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya![1]

Gaura's pastimes with the devotees in Nīlācala —

এইমত গৌরচন্দ্র নিজভক্ত-সঙ্গে ।
নীলাচলে ক্রীড়া করে কৃষ্ণপ্রেমতরঙ্গে ॥ ৪ ॥

ei-mata gauracandra nija-bhakta-saṅge
in this way Gauracandra His own devotees with
nīlācale krīḍā kare kṛṣṇa-prema-taraṅge
in Nīlācala plays makes of love for Kṛṣṇa in the waves

4 In this way Gauracandra enjoyed His pastimes in Nīlācala with His own devotees, amid the waves of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
Here another reading has: "Glory, glory to Nityānanda, the moon among *avadhūtas*, who bound the world with the noose of prema! Glory, glory to Śrī Advaita, the incarnation of Īśvara, who made Kṛṣṇa descend and delivered the world!"

হেনকালে রামচন্দ্রপুরী-গোসাঞি আইলা ।
পরমানন্দ-পুরীরে আর প্রভুরে মিলিলা ॥ ৫ ॥

hena-kāle rāmacandra-purī-gosāñi āilā
at this time Rāmacandra Purī Gosāñi came
paramānanda-purīre āra prabhure mililā
Paramānanda Purī and the Lord met

5 At that time Rāmacandra Purī Gosāñi came and met Paramānanda Purī and the Lord.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rāmacandra Purī was a disciple of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī; therefore Mahāprabhu and Paramānanda Purī showed him honour.

Rāmacandra Purī arrives —

পরমানন্দ-পুরী কৈল চরণ বন্দন ।
পুরী-গোসাঞি কৈল তাঁরে দৃঢ় আলিঙ্গন ॥ ৬ ॥

paramānanda-purī kaila caraṇa vandana
Paramānanda Purī did at the feet homage
purī-gosāñi kaila tāṁre dṛḍha āliṅgana
Purī Gosāñi gave him a firm embrace

6 Paramānanda Purī paid homage at his feet, and Purī Gosāñi embraced him firmly.

Anubhāṣya.
By nature Rāmacandra Purī was envious and hostile to Hari, guru and the Vaiṣṇavas. Outwardly, however, he had left home, that is, he wore the dress of a sannyāsī, and for that reason alone people of that time called him "Gosāñi" (Gosvāmī). This shows that the title, befitting those who have left home, was not then given by caste, family or heredity, as it is now by a distorted social custom.

The customary conduct of Vaiṣṇava sannyāsīs in the sampradāya —

মহাপ্রভু কৈলা তাঁরে দণ্ডবৎ নতি ।
আলিঙ্গন করি' তেঁহো কৈল কৃষ্ণস্মৃতি ॥ ৭ ॥

mahāprabhu kailā tāṁre daṇḍavat nati
Mahāprabhu made to him prostrate obeisance
āliṅgana kari' teṁho kaila kṛṣṇa-smṛti
embrace giving he made of Kṛṣṇa remembrance

7 Mahāprabhu offered him prostrate obeisance; he embraced the Lord and remembered Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
Taking Mahāprabhu to be a follower of Īśvara Purī, Rāmacandra Purī embraced Him and remembered Kṛṣṇa, the greeting proper to every Vaiṣṇava sannyāsī. When

sannyāsīs are greeted, they answer, "*Oṁ namo bhagavate nārāyaṇāya*," and so remember Kṛṣṇa. A sannyāsī is not supposed to bless living beings or to bow to them; the *smṛti* says: "A sannyāsī neither blesses nor offers obeisances."

Jagadānanda gives him a meal —

তিনজনে ইষ্টগোষ্ঠী কৈলা কতক্ষণ ।
জগদানন্দ-পণ্ডিত তাঁরে কৈলা নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৮ ॥

tina-jane iṣṭa-goṣṭhī kailā kata-kṣaṇa
the three persons about the Lord conversation held for some time
jagadānanda-paṇḍita tāṁre kailā nimantraṇa
Jagadānanda Paṇḍita him invited

8 For some time the three of them spoke together about the Lord. Then Jagadānanda Paṇḍita invited him for a meal.

Having eaten more than enough himself, he blames the host or the one who served —

জগন্নাথের প্রসাদ আনিলা ভিক্ষার লাগিয়া ।
যথেষ্ট ভিক্ষা করিলা তেঁহো নিন্দার লাগিয়া ॥ ৯ ॥

jagannāthera prasāda ānilā bhikṣāra lāgiyā
Jagannātha's prasāda he brought of the meal for the sake
yatheṣṭa bhikṣā karilā teṁho nindāra lāgiyā
as much as he liked meal ate he of fault-finding for the sake

9 Jagadānanda brought Jagannātha's prasāda for the meal, and Rāmacandra Purī ate as much as he liked, only to find fault afterwards.

Having himself fed Jagadānanda abundantly, he blames Gaura's associates as gluttons —

ভিক্ষা করি' কহে পুরী, — শুন, জগদানন্দ ।
অবশেষ প্রসাদ তুমি করহ ভক্ষণ ॥ ১০ ॥

bhikṣā kari' kahe purī, — śuna, jagadānanda
meal having taken says Purī listen Jagadānanda
avaśeṣa prasāda tumi karaha bhakṣaṇa
the remnants of prasāda you do eat

10 When he had eaten, the Purī said, "Listen, Jagadānanda: you eat the prasāda that remains."

আগ্রহ করিয়া তাঁরে বসি' খাওয়াইল ।
আপনে আগ্রহ করি' পরিবেশন কৈল ॥ ১১ ॥

āgraha kariyā tāṁre vasi' khāoyāila
insistence showing him having seated fed
āpane āgraha kari' pariveśana kaila
himself insistence showing serving did

11 He insisted on seating Jagadānanda and feeding him, and eagerly served the food himself.

আগ্রহ করিয়া পুনঃ পুনঃ খাওয়াইল ।
আচমন কৈলে নিন্দা করিতে লাগিল ॥ ১২ ॥

āgraha kariyā punaḥ punaḥ khāoyāila
insistence showing again and again fed
ācamana kaile nindā karite lāgila
rinsing of the mouth when he did fault-finding to do began

12 Again and again he pressed him to eat; and when Jagadānanda had rinsed his mouth, he began to find fault:

Gaura's associates, truly possessed of pure renunciation, he blames as lacking renunciation —

শুনি, চৈতন্যগণ করে বহুত ভক্ষণ ।
'সত্য' সেই বাক্য, — সাক্ষাৎ দেখিলুঁ এখন ॥ ১৩ ॥

śuni, caitanya-gaṇa kare bahuta bhakṣaṇa
I heard Caitanya's followers make much eating
'satya' sei vākya, — sākṣāt dekhiluṁ ekhana
'true' that saying with my own eyes I have seen now

13 "I had heard that Caitanya's followers eat a great deal. That report is true: now I have seen it with my own eyes.

সন্ন্যাসীরে এত খাওয়াঞা করে ধর্ম্ম নাশ ।
বৈরাগী হঞা এত খায়, বৈরাগ্যের নাহি 'ভাস' ॥ ১৪ ॥

sannyāsīre eta khāoyāñā kare dharma nāśa
a sannyāsī so much feeding they make of dharma ruin
vairāgī hañā eta khāya, vairāgyera nāhi 'bhāsa'
renunciants being so much they eat of renunciation there is not 'a semblance'

14 Feeding a sannyāsī so much, they ruin his dharma; and though they are renunciants, they eat so much that they have not even a semblance of renunciation!"

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhāsa — even a mere semblance (*ābhāsa*).

Rāmacandra Purī's nature —

এই ত' স্বভাব তাঁর আগ্রহ করিয়া ।
পিছে নিন্দা করে, আগে বহুত খাওয়াঞা ॥ ১৫ ॥

ei ta' svabhāva tāṁra āgraha kariyā
this indeed the nature his insistence showing
piche nindā kare, āge bahuta khāoyāñā
afterwards fault-finding makes first much having fed

15 This was his nature: first he would insist on feeding someone a great deal, and afterwards he would find fault with him.

The earlier history of Rāmacandra Purī, rejected by his guru; Rāmacandra comes when his gurudeva, Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, is departing from this world —

পূর্ব্বে যবে মাধবেন্দ্রপুরী করেন অন্তর্দ্ধান ।
রামচন্দ্রপুরী তবে আইলা তাঁর স্থান ॥ ১৬ ॥

pūrve yabe mādhavendra purī karena antarddhāna
formerly when Mādhavendra Purī made departure from the world
rāmacandra-purī tabe āilā tāṁra sthāna
Rāmacandra Purī then came his to the place

16 Formerly, when Mādhavendra Purī was departing from this world, Rāmacandra Purī came to him.

Śrī Mādhavendra Purī chants of Kṛṣṇa in the transcendental rasa of separation (vipralambha) —

পুরী-গোসাঞি করেন কৃষ্ণনাম-সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
মথুরা না পাইনু বলি' করেন ক্রন্দন ॥ ১৭ ॥

purī-gosāñi karena kṛṣṇa-nāma-saṅkīrtana
Purī Gosāñi makes of Kṛṣṇa's name chanting
mathurā nā pāinu bali' karena krandana
Mathurā not I have attained saying makes weeping

17 Purī Gosāñi was chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa and weeping: "I have not attained Mathurā!"

The dry speculator Rāmacandra, thinking his guru mortal, oversteps the respect due to him —

রামচন্দ্রপুরী তবে উপদেশে তাঁরে ।
শিষ্য হঞা গুরুকে কহে, ভয় নাহি করে ॥ ১৮ ॥

rāmacandra-purī tabe upadeśe tāṁre
Rāmacandra Purī then instructs him
śiṣya hañā guruke kahe, bhaya nāhi kare
disciple being to the guru he speaks fear not does

18 Then Rāmacandra Purī instructed him. Though a disciple, he spoke to his guru without fear:

Rāmacandra opposes the spiritual pastimes (cid-vilāsa) —

তুমি — পূর্ণ ব্রহ্মানন্দ, করহ স্মরণ ।
ব্রহ্মবিৎ হঞা কেনে করহ রোদন ? ॥ ১৯ ॥

tumi — pūrṇa brahmānanda, karaha smaraṇa
you full the bliss of Brahman do remember
brahmavit hañā kene karaha rodana?
knower of Brahman being why do weeping

19 "You are full of the bliss of Brahman — remember it! You are a knower of Brahman: why do you weep?"

His guru, Mādhavendra Purī, seeing Rāmacandra as an offender, angrily rejects and rebukes him —

শুনি' মাধবেন্দ্র-মনে ক্রোধ উপজিল ।
দূর, দূর, পাপিষ্ঠ বলি' ভর্ৎসনা করিল ॥ ২০ ॥

śuni' mādhavendra-mane krodha upajila
hearing in Mādhavendra's mind anger arose
dūra, dūra, pāpiṣṭha bali' bhartsanā karila
away away most sinful one saying rebuke made

20 Hearing this, Mādhavendra Purī grew angry. "Away, away, you sinner!" he cried, and rebuked him.

Anubhāṣya.
Rāmacandra Purī saw that his guru, Śrī Mādhavendra, was suffering in separation from Śrī Kṛṣṇa, but he could not understand that this was the manifestation of transcendental separation (*vipralambha*). Reasoning in a worldly way and thinking his

guru mortal, he concluded that his guru was grieving over some material lack, and he hastened to make him realise the impersonal Brahman. Then Mādhavendra Purī, seeing his disciple's foolishness and disrespect for the guru, ceased wishing him well, rejected him and drove him away.

'কৃষ্ণ-কৃপা' না পাইনু, না পাইনু 'মথুরা' ৷
আপন-দুঃখে মরোঁ, — এই দিতে আইল জ্বালা ॥ ২১ ॥

'kṛṣṇa-kṛpā' nā pāinu, nā pāinu 'mathurā'
'Kṛṣṇa's mercy' not I have attained not I have attained 'Mathurā'
āpana-duḥkhe maroṁ, — ei dite āila jvālā
in my own grief I am dying this one to give came burning pain

21 "I have not attained Kṛṣṇa's mercy, I have not attained Mathurā. I am leaving this world in my own grief, and now this one has come to add to my burning pain!

মোরে মুখ না দেখাবি তুই, যাও যথি-তথি ৷
তোরে দেখি' মৈলে, মোর হবে অসদ্গতি ॥ ২২ ॥

more mukha nā dekhābi tui, yāo yathi-tathi
to me face not you shall show you go wherever
tore dekhi' maile, mora habe asad-gati
you seeing if I die my will be an evil end

22 Never show me your face again; go wherever you like! If I leave this world while looking at you, I shall come to an evil end.

কৃষ্ণ না পাইনু মরোঁ আপনার দুঃখে ৷
মোরে 'ব্রহ্ম' উপদেশে এই ছার মূর্খে ॥ ২৩ ॥

kṛṣṇa nā pāinu maroṁ āpanāra duḥkhe
Kṛṣṇa not I have attained I am dying in my own grief
more 'brahma' upadeśe ei chāra mūrkhe
to me 'Brahman' teaches this wretched fool

23 I am leaving this world in my own grief, not having attained Kṛṣṇa, and now this wretched fool would teach me about Brahman!”

Through the offence of disrespect for the guru arises the desire for sense enjoyment, that is, worldly desire —

এই যে শ্রীমাধবেন্দ্রপাদ উপেক্ষা করিল ।
সেই অপরাধে ইঁহার ‘বাসনা’ জন্মিল ॥ ২৪ ॥

ei ye śrī-mādhavendrapāda upekṣā karila
this that Śrī Mādhavendrapāda disregard made
sei aparādhe iṁhāra ‘vāsanā’ janmila
by that offence his ‘worldly desires’ were born

24 Śrī Mādhavendrapāda thus disregarded him, and through that offence worldly desires (*vāsanā*) were born in Rāmacandra Purī.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Vāsanā — the desire for dry knowledge; from it arises blasphemy of the devotees.[12]

Anubhāṣya.

On this subject see such statements of scripture as these. The *Bhakti-sandarbha* (no. 111) quotes the words of the *Bhagavat-pariśiṣṭa* from the *Vāsanā-bhāṣya*: “Even those liberated in this life return to worldly desires if they offend the Lord of inconceivable, great power.” Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, in his commentary *Laghu-toṣaṇī* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.32, quotes another reading of the same words of the *Bhagavat-pariśiṣṭa* from the *Vāsanā-bhāṣya*: “Even those liberated in this life again fall into bondage through karma if they offend the Lord of inconceivable, great power.” And the *Śrī Viṣṇu-bhakti-candrodaya*, in connection with the Ratha-yātrā, quotes the words of another Purāṇa: “Those liberated in this life sometimes fall into worldly desires; but yogīs devoted to the Lord are not stained by karma.”

Not seeing the spiritual variety — Kṛṣṇa and what belongs to Kṛṣṇa (kārṣṇa), that is, His svarūpa, tad-rūpa-vaibhava and so on — he begins to blaspheme

Viṣṇu —

শুষ্ক-ব্রহ্মজ্ঞানী, নাহি কৃষ্ণের 'সম্বন্ধ' ।
সর্ব্বলোকের নিন্দা করে, নিন্দাতে নির্ব্বন্ধ ॥ ২৫ ॥

śuṣka-brahma-jñānī, nāhi kṛṣṇera 'sambandha'
dry Brahman knower there is not with Kṛṣṇa 'relationship'
sarva-lokera nindā kare, nindāte nirbandha
of all people fault-finding makes in fault-finding stubbornly fixed

25 A dry knower of Brahman, he had no relationship with Kṛṣṇa. He found fault with everyone and stubbornly persisted in it.

Anubhāṣya.

Nirbandha — a stubborn attachment to blaming others. The impersonalist Māyāvādīs are unskilled in knowledge of relationship (*sambandha-jñāna*), and so they cannot accept a relationship with Kṛṣṇa. By the force of mundane argument they apply mundane logic to Brahman. They take devotion to Kṛṣṇa for one of the rites of *karma-kāṇḍa*, which the seeker of liberation resorts to and which is rooted in the thirst to enjoy fruits. And they blame the Lord's devotees and their transcendental cultivation of devotion, thinking it merely a karmic practice that yields the four goals of life (*catur-varga*). A living being falls into such terrible ignorance only when he offends the feet of the guru or devotee who is beyond the senses (*adhokṣaja*).

Śrīla Īśvara Purī's exclusive devotion to his guru —

ঈশ্বরপুরী করেন শ্রীপাদ-সেবন ।
স্বহস্তে করেন মলমূত্রাদি মার্জ্জন ॥ ২৬ ॥

īśvara-purī karena śrīpāda-sevana
Īśvara Purī does to Śrīpāda service
svahaste karena malamūtrādi mārjana
with his own hands does stool, urine and the rest cleaning

26 Īśvara Purī, however, served Śrīpāda Mādhavendra Purī, cleaning away his stool and urine with his own hands.[2]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīpāda-sevana — service to Śrī Mādhavendra Purīpāda.

An example of ideal service to the guru —

নিরন্তর কৃষ্ণনাম করায় স্মরণ ।
কৃষ্ণনাম, কৃষ্ণলীলা শুনায় অনুক্ষণ ॥ ২৭ ॥

nirantara kṛṣṇa-nāma karāya smaraṇa
constantly Kṛṣṇa's name makes him remember
kṛṣṇa-nāma, kṛṣṇa-līlā śunāya anukṣaṇa
Kṛṣṇa's name, Kṛṣṇa's pastimes makes him hear every moment

27 He constantly helped him remember the name of Kṛṣṇa, and at every moment let him hear Kṛṣṇa's name and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes.

Śrī Īśvara Purī receives his guru's grace —

তুষ্ট হঞা পুরী তাঁরে কৈলা আলিঙ্গন ।
বর দিলা, — কৃষ্ণে তোমার হউক প্রেমধন ॥ ২৮ ॥

tuṣṭa hañā purī tāṁre kailā āliṅgana
pleased being Purī him gave an embrace
vara dilā, — kṛṣṇe tomāra hauka prema-dhana
blessing gave for Kṛṣṇa your may there be of love the treasure

28 Pleased with him, Purī Gosāñi embraced him and gave him a blessing: "May you have the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa!"

The difference in results: one obtained the guru's mercy, the other his displeasure and was therefore left deprived —

সেই হৈতে ঈশ্বরপুরী — 'প্রেমের সাগর' ।
রামচন্দ্রপুরী হৈল সর্ব্বনিন্দাকর ॥ ২৯ ॥

sei haite īśvara-purī — 'premera sāgara'
that from Īśvara Purī 'of love an ocean'
rāmacandra-purī haila sarva-nindākara
Rāmacandra Purī became of everyone a fault-finder

29 From then on Īśvara Purī was an ocean of love, while Rāmacandra Purī became one who found fault with everyone.

Through two examples — of receiving the mercy and the punishment of Hari, guru and the Vaiṣṇavas — the world is taught —

মহদনুগ্রহ-নিগ্রহের ‘সাক্ষী’ দুইজনে ।
এই দুইদ্বারে শিখাইলা জগজনে ॥ ৩০ ॥

mahad-anugraha-nigrahera ‘sākṣī’ dui-jane
of a great soul’s mercy punishment ‘witnesses’ the two persons
ei dui-dvāre śikhāilā jaga-jane
these two through taught the world’s people

30 The two of them are witnesses of a great soul’s mercy and punishment; through these two he taught the people of the world.

Anubhāṣya.
From the great soul Śrīla Mādhavendra Purī, Īśvara Purī received abundant mercy (*anugraha*), while Rāmacandra Purī received only punishment (*nigraha*).

Mādhavendra Gosvāmī departs from the manifest world in the transcendental state of separation —

জগদ্গুরু মাধবেন্দ্র করি’ প্রেম দান ।
এই শ্লোক পড়ি’ তেঁহো করিলা অন্তর্দ্ধান ॥ ৩১ ॥

jagad-guru mādhavendra kari’ prema dāna
of the world guru Mādhavendra making of love a gift
ei śloka paḍi’ teṁho karilā antarddhāna
this verse reciting he made departure from the world

31 Having given the gift of love, Mādhavendra, the guru of the world, recited this verse and departed from this world:

(The words of Mādhavendra Purī quoted in the Padyāvalī, no. 330)

অয়ি দীনদয়ার্দ্র নাথ হে
মথুরানাথ কদাবলোক্যসে ৷
হৃদয়ং ত্বদলোককাতরং
দয়িত ভ্রাম্যতি কিং করোম্যহম্ ॥ ৩২ ॥

ayi dīna-dayārdra nātha he
O melting with compassion for the wretched Lord O
mathurā-nātha kadāvalokyase
of Mathurā Lord when shall You be seen
hṛdayaṁ tvad-aloka-kātaraṁ
heart at not seeing You stricken
dayita bhrāmyati kiṁ karomy aham
O Beloved wanders what do I

32 "O Lord, melting with compassion for the wretched! O Lord of Mathurā, when shall I see You? My heart, stricken at not seeing You, has lost all rest. O Beloved, what am I to do?" (Padyāvalī, 330)[3]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 4.197.

The inner meaning, that is, the purport of the verse —

এই শ্লোকে কৃষ্ণপ্রেম করে উপদেশ ৷
কৃষ্ণের বিরহে, ভক্তের ভাববিশেষ ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ei śloke kṛṣṇa-prema kare upadeśa
in this verse love for Kṛṣṇa makes teaching
kṛṣṇera virahe, bhaktera bhāva-viśeṣa
of Kṛṣṇa in separation of the devotee bhāva special

33 This verse teaches love for Kṛṣṇa — the special feeling (*bhāva-viśeṣa*) a devotee knows in separation from Him.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhāva-viśeṣa (a special feeling) — the manifestation of the feeling of separation. In the community of the *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, practitioners commit all kinds of excesses in the name of *sambhoga* (union), and so they obstruct the realisation of the true nature of separation (*vipralambha*).

Mādhavendra is the sprout of the wish-fulfilling tree of love for Kṛṣṇa; Śrī Caitanya Himself is the main tree, grown from that sprout and fully developed —

পৃথিবীতে রোপণ করি' গেলা প্রেমাঙ্কুর ।
সেই প্রেমাঙ্কুরের বৃক্ষ — চৈতন্যঠাকুর ॥ ৩৪ ॥

pṛthivīte ropaṇa kari' gelā premāṅkura
on the earth planting making went of love the sprout
sei premāṅkurera vṛkṣa — caitanya-ṭhākura
that of love of the sprout the tree Caitanya Ṭhākura

34 He planted the sprout of love on the earth and departed. Śrī Caitanya Ṭhākura is the tree that grew from that sprout of love.

Hearing of Mādhavendra's departure, living beings learn service born of separation from Kṛṣṇa —

প্রস্তাবে কহিলুঁ পুরী-গোসাঞির নির্য্যাণ ।
যেই ইহা শুনে, সেই বড় ভাগ্যবান্ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

prastāve kahiluṁ purī-gosāñira niryāṇa
in this context I have told Purī Gosāñi's departure
yei ihā śune, sei baḍa bhāgyavān
whoever this hears he very fortunate

35 In this context I have told of Purī Gosāñi's departure from this world. Whoever hears of it is greatly fortunate.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Niryāṇa — departure from the manifest world (*aprakaṭa*).

Rāmacandra Purī's dry renunciation —

রামচন্দ্রপুরী ঐছে রহিলা নীলাচলে ।
বিরক্ত স্বভাব, কভু রহে কোন স্থলে ॥ ৩৬ ॥

rāmacandra-purī aiche rahilā nīlācale
Rāmacandra Purī thus stayed in Nīlācala
virakta svabhāva, kabhu rahe kona sthale
renounced by nature sometimes stays in some place

36 So Rāmacandra Purī stayed on in Nīlācala. Renounced by nature, he would stay now in one place, now in another.

Rāmacandra Purī hunts for the faults of others —

অনিমন্ত্রণ ভিক্ষা করে, নাহিক নির্ণয় ।
অন্যের ভিক্ষার স্থিতির লয়েন নিশ্চয় ॥ ৩৭ ॥

animantraṇa bhikṣā kare, nāhika nirṇaya
uninvited meal takes there is no fixed rule
anyera bhikṣāra sthitira layena niścaya
of others' meals the arrangement takes account

37 He took his meals uninvited, with no fixed rule, and he kept account of how others took their meals.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Anyera bhikṣāra sthitira — he found out the rule of other people's meals: what and how much they eat.

Anubhāṣya.
"Rāmacandra Purī passes his days keeping an account of others' affairs: where another sannyāsī takes alms and how much, where he stays, and so on." *Niścaya* — account.

The Lord's daily meals: Govinda and Kāśīśvara, disciples of Śrī Īśvara Purī,

ate together with the Lord —

প্রভুর নিমন্ত্রণে লাগে কৌড়ি চারি পণ ।
কভু কাশীশ্বর, গোবিন্দ খান তিন জন ॥ ৩৮ ॥

prabhura nimantraṇe lāge kauḍi cāri paṇa
the Lord's for the invitation is needed cowries four paṇas
kabhu kāśīśvara, govinda khāna tina jana
sometimes Kāśīśvara Govinda eat three persons

38 To invite the Lord for a meal cost four paṇas of cowries, for sometimes Kāśīśvara and Govinda ate as well, three persons in all.[4]

প্রত্যহ প্রভুর ভিক্ষা ইতি-উতি হয় ।
কেহ যদি মূল্য আনে, চারিপণ-নির্ণয় ॥ ৩৯ ॥

pratyaha prabhura bhikṣā iti-uti haya
daily the Lord's meal here and there is
keha yadi mūlya āne, cāri-paṇa-nirṇaya
someone if the price brings four paṇas fixed

39 Every day the Lord took His meal at one place or another. If someone brought money for it, the amount was fixed at four paṇas.

Thinking even the Lord Himself mortal, he seeks faults in Him —

প্রভুর স্থিতি, রীতি, ভিক্ষা, শয়ন, প্রয়াণ ।
রামচন্দ্রপুরী করে সর্ব্বানুসন্ধান ॥ ৪০ ॥

prabhura sthiti, rīti, bhikṣā, śayana, prayāṇa
the Lord's stay ways meals sleep going out
rāmacandra-purī kare sarvānusandhāna
Rāmacandra Purī makes all inquiry

40 Rāmacandra Purī inquired into everything about the Lord: where He stayed, His ways, His meals, His sleep and His going out.

Svayam Bhagavān, Adhokṣaja, is complete and faultless —

প্রভুর যতেক গুণ স্পর্শিতে নারিল ।
ছিদ্র চাহি' বুলে, কাঁহা ছিদ্র না পাইল ॥ ৪১ ॥

prabhura yateka guṇa sparśite nārila
the Lord's all qualities to touch could not
chidra cāhi' bule, kāṁhā chidra nā pāila
faults seeking he goes about anywhere fault not found

41 He could not grasp a single one of the Lord's virtues. He went about seeking faults, but found none anywhere.

Injunctions and prohibitions for a sannyāsī —

সন্ন্যাসী হঞা করে মিষ্টান্ন ভক্ষণ ।
এই ভোগে হয় কৈছে ইন্দ্রিয়-বারণ ? ॥ ৪২ ॥

sannyāsī hañā kare miṣṭānna bhakṣaṇa
a sannyāsī being makes of sweets eating
ei bhoge haya kaiche indriya-vāraṇa?
by this enjoyment is how of the senses control

42 "He is a sannyāsī, yet He eats sweets! With such enjoyment, how can there be control of the senses?"

He blames the Lord everywhere, yet comes to see Him every day —

এই নিন্দা করি' কহে সর্ব্বলোক-স্থানে ।
প্রভুরে দেখিতেহ অবশ্য আইসে প্রতিদিনে ॥ ৪৩ ॥

ei nindā kari' kahe sarva-loka-sthāne
this fault-finding making he speaks of all people in the presence
prabhure dekhiteha avaśya āise prati-dine
the Lord to see still he comes every day

43 Finding this fault, he spoke of it before everyone; and yet he came every day to see the Lord.

The Lord gives him the milk of respect; Rāmacandra spews the poison of blame —

প্রভু গুরুবুদ্ধ্যে করেন সম্ভ্রম, সম্মান ।
তেঁহো ছিদ্র চাহি' বুলে, — এই তার কাম ॥ ৪৪ ॥

prabhu guru-buddhye karena sambhrama, sammāna
the Lord as a guru regarding him makes reverence honour
teṁho chidra cāhi' bule, — ei tāra kāma
he faults seeking goes about this his occupation

44 Regarding him as a guru, the Lord showed him reverence and honour, but he went about looking for faults — that was his occupation.

Even hearing Himself blamed, the Lord gives Purī the honour due to his position, and thereby deceives him —

যত নিন্দা করে তাহা প্রভু সব জানে ।
তথাপি আদর করে বড়ই সম্ভ্রমে ॥ ৪৫ ॥

yata nindā kare tāhā prabhu saba jāne
whatever fault-finding he makes that the Lord all knows
tathāpi ādara kare baḍai sambhrame
still respect makes very great with reverence

45 The Lord knew all the fault-finding he did, yet He still treated him with great respect and reverence.

One morning, seeing lines of ants in the Lord's house, he blames the renunciation of the Lord, Svayam Bhagavān, and leaves —

একদিন প্রাতঃকালে আইলা প্রভুর ঘর ।
পিপীলিকা দেখি' কিছু কহেন উত্তর ॥ ৪৬ ॥

ekadina prātaḥ-kāle āilā prabhura ghara
one day in the morning came of the Lord to the house
pipīlikā dekhi' kichu kahena uttara
ants seeing something says in reply

46 One morning he came to the Lord's house. Seeing ants there, he made a remark:

(The words of Rāmacandra Purī)

রাত্রাবত্র ঐক্ষবমাসীৎ,
তেন পিপীলিকাঃ সঞ্চরন্তি ৷ অহো !
বিরক্তানাং সন্ন্যাসিনামিয়মিন্দ্রিয়-
লালসেতি ব্রুবন্নুত্থায় গতঃ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

rātrāv atra aikṣavam āsīt,
at night here sugarcane molasses was
tena pipīlikāḥ sañcaranti. aho!
therefore ants are moving about alas
viraktānāṁ sannyāsinām iyam indriya-
of renounced sannyāsīs this for the senses
lālaseti bruvannutthāya gataḥ
craving so saying getting up he went

47 "Last night there was sugarcane molasses here; that is why the ants are crawling about. Alas! Such is the craving of the senses in renounced sannyāsīs!" Saying this, he got up and left.[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Last night there was cane molasses (*guḍa*) here; that is why the ants are crawling about. Alas, such is the craving of renounced sannyāsīs for sense enjoyment!" Saying this, he got up and left.

Anubhāṣya.

Mahāprabhu is Svayam Bhagavān, the complete and faultless form, beyond such material qualities as contemptibility. Rāmacandra tried hard to find some fault or other in Him but did not succeed. He saw no sweets of any kind in the Lord's house, but, noticing many ants crawling about, he guessed that there had been molasses there at night. His aim was to point out some fault and thereby magnify himself.

With His own ears the Lord hears Purī's false blame —

প্রভু পরম্পরায় নিন্দা কৈরাছেন শ্রবণ ।
এবে সাক্ষাৎ শুনিলেন 'কল্পিত' নিন্দন ॥ ৪৮ ॥

prabhu paramparāya nindā kairāchena śravaṇa
the Lord through others fault-finding had heard
ebe sākṣāt śunilena 'kalpita' nindana
now directly He heard 'invented' blame

48 The Lord had heard of his fault-finding through others; now He heard the invented blame with His own ears.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kalpita nindana — a falsely imputed accusation.

Faults are imputed to Bhagavān only under the sway of misapprehension (vivarta) —

সহজেই পিপীলিকা সর্ব্বত্র বেড়ায় ।
তাহাতে তর্ক উঠাঞা দোষ লাগায় ॥ ৪৯ ॥

sahajei pipīlikā sarvatra beḍāya
naturally ants everywhere wander
tāhāte tarka uṭhāñā doṣa lāgāya
in that argument raising a fault he attaches

49 Ants naturally wander about everywhere, yet he raised an argument from it and attached a fault to the Lord.

Hearing Himself blamed, the Lord, in the role of the ācārya, the guru of the world, feels fear and shame —

শুনি' তাহা প্রভুর সঙ্কোচ-ভয় মনে ।
গোবিন্দে বোলাঞা কিছু কহেন বচনে ॥ ৫০ ॥

śuni' tāhā prabhura saṅkoca-bhaya mane
hearing that of the Lord embarrassment fear in the mind
govinde bolāñā kichu kahena vacane
Govinda calling some says words

50 Hearing this, the Lord felt embarrassment and fear in His mind. He called Govinda and spoke to him:

The Lord reduces His daily meal and fixes its measure with Govinda —

আজি হৈতে ভিক্ষা আমার এই ত' নিয়ম ।
পিণ্ডাভোগের এক চৌঠি, পাঁচগণ্ডার ব্যঞ্জন ॥ ৫১ ॥

āji haite bhikṣā āmāra ei ta' niyama
today from meal My this indeed rule
piṇḍā-bhogera eka cauṭhi, pāṁca-gaṇḍāra vyañjana
of the piṇḍā-bhoga one quarter of five gaṇḍās' worth vegetables

51 "From today this is the rule for My meals: a quarter-pot of the rice offered on Jagannātha's altar (*piṇḍā-bhoga*), and vegetables worth five gaṇḍās.

Anubhāṣya.
The rice prasāda of Jagannāthadeva is obtained in clay pots. A quarter of a pot of the standard measure (*pramāṇa*) is called *ek-cauṭhi*.

He threatens to leave the place if more than this measure is taken —

ইহা বই অধিক আর কিছু না লইবা ।
অধিক আনিলে আমা এথা না দেখিবা ॥ ৫২ ॥

ihā bai adhika āra kichu nā laibā
this except more other anything not you shall take
adhika ānile āmā ethā nā dekhibā
more if you bring Me here not you shall see

52 Take nothing more than this. If you bring more, you will not see Me here again."

The Lord's stern order is announced to all the devotees; all are in terrible grief —

সকল বৈষ্ণবে গোবিন্দ কহে এই বাত্ ।
শুনি' সবার মাথে যৈছে হৈল বজ্রাঘাত ॥ ৫৩ ॥

sakala vaiṣṇave govinda kahe ei bāt
to all the Vaiṣṇavas Govinda tells this news
śuni' sabāra māthe yaiche haila vajrāghāta
hearing of everyone on the head as if there was a thunderbolt's stroke

53 Govinda told all the Vaiṣṇavas this news. Hearing it, they felt as if a thunderbolt had struck their heads.

The devotees blame the wicked Rāmacandra Purī, seeing him as the opponent of the Lord, who is dearer to them than life —

রামচন্দ্রপুরীকে সবায় দেয় তিরস্কার ।
এই পাপিষ্ঠ আসি' প্রাণ লইল সবার ॥ ৫৪ ॥

rāmacandra-purīke sabāya deya tiraskāra
Rāmacandra Purī everyone gives rebuke
ei pāpiṣṭha āsi' prāṇa laila sabāra
this great sinner coming life has taken of all

54 Everyone reproached Rāmacandra Purī: "This sinner has come here and taken the life of us all!"

Govinda takes prasāda for the Lord only in the prescribed measure; the brāhmaṇa grieves that the Lord eats so little —

সেইদিন একবিপ্র কৈল নিমন্ত্রণ ।
এক-চৌঠি ভাত, পাঁচ-গণ্ডার ব্যঞ্জন ॥ ৫৫ ॥

এই মাত্র গোবিন্দ কৈল অঙ্গীকার ।
মাথায় ঘা মারে বিপ্র, করে হাহাকার ॥ ৫৬ ॥

sei-dina eka-vipra kaila nimantraṇa
that day a brāhmaṇa made invitation
eka-cauṭhi bhāta, pāṁca-gaṇḍāra vyañjana
one quarter-pot rice of five gaṇḍās' worth vegetables
ei mātra govinda kaila aṅgīkāra
this only Govinda made acceptance
māthāya ghā māre vipra, kare hāhākāra
on his head blows strikes the brāhmaṇa makes lamentation

55–56 That day a brāhmaṇa invited the Lord. Govinda accepted only a quarter-pot of rice and vegetables worth five gaṇḍās, and the brāhmaṇa struck his head and cried out in grief.

The Lord eats half, Govinda receives the remaining half; the devotees give up food and water —

সেই ভাত-ব্যঞ্জন প্রভু অর্দ্ধেক খাইল ।
যে কিছু রহিল, তাহা গোবিন্দ পাইল ॥ ৫৭ ॥

sei bhāta-vyañjana prabhu arddheka khāila
that rice vegetables the Lord half ate
ye kichu rahila, tāhā govinda pāila
whatever remained that Govinda received

57 The Lord ate half of the rice and vegetables, and whatever remained Govinda received.

অর্দ্ধাশন করেন প্রভু, গোবিন্দ অর্দ্ধাশন ।
সব ভক্তগণ তবে ছাড়িল ভোজন ॥ ৫৮ ॥

arddhāśana karena prabhu, govinda arddhāśana
half a meal takes the Lord Govinda half a meal
saba bhakta-gaṇa tabe chāḍila bhojana
all the devotees then gave up eating

58 The Lord ate half a meal and Govinda half a meal, and then all the devotees gave up eating.[6]

The Lord tells Govinda and Kāśīśvara to take their meals elsewhere —

গোবিন্দ-কাশীশ্বরে প্রভুর কৈলা আজ্ঞাপন ।
দুঁহে অন্যত্র মাগি' কর উদর ভরণ ॥ ৫৯ ॥

govinda-kāśīśvare prabhura kailā ājñāpana
to Govinda Kāśīśvara the Lord's was made order
duṁhe anyatra māgi' kara udara bharaṇa
you two elsewhere begging do of the belly filling

59 The Lord ordered Govinda and Kāśīśvara, "You two beg elsewhere and fill your stomachs."

Hearing that the devotees grieve because the Lord has reduced His eating, Rāmacandra comes to the Lord —

এইরূপ মহাদুঃখে দিন কত গেল ।
শুনি' রামচন্দ্রপুরী প্রভু-পাশ আইল ॥ ৬০ ॥

ei-rūpa mahā-duḥkhe dina kata gela
in this way in great grief days some passed
śuni' rāmacandra-purī prabhu-pāśa āila
hearing Rāmacandra Purī the Lord near came

60 Some days passed in this great grief. Hearing of it, Rāmacandra Purī came to the Lord.

The Lord, in the role of the ācārya who honours others (mānada), always honours Rāmacandra —

প্রণাম করি' প্রভু কৈলা চরণ বন্দন ।
প্রভুরে কহয়ে কিছু হাসিয়া বচন ॥ ৬১ ॥

praṇāma kari' prabhu kailā caraṇa vandana
obeisance making the Lord did at the feet homage
prabhure kahaye kichu hāsiyā vacana
to the Lord says some smiling words

61 The Lord bowed down and paid homage at his feet, and the Purī, smiling, spoke to the Lord:

He instructs the Lord in the dharma of a renunciant (yati-dharma) —

সন্ন্যাসীর ধর্ম্ম নহে 'ইন্দ্রিয়-তর্পণ' ।
যৈছে তৈছে করে মাত্র উদর ভরণ ॥ ৬২ ॥

sannyāsīra dharma nahe 'indriya-tarpaṇa'
a sannyāsī's dharma is not 'of the senses gratification'
yaiche taiche kare mātra udara bharaṇa
somehow or other makes only of the belly filling

62 "A sannyāsī's dharma is not to gratify the senses. He just fills his stomach somehow or other.

Only in words does he preach that dry renunciation is contrary to sannyāsa, that is, to bhakti —

তোমারে ক্ষীণ দেখি, শুনি, — কর অর্দ্ধাশন ।
এই 'শুষ্ক-বৈরাগ্য' নহে সন্ন্যাসীর 'ধর্ম্ম' ॥ ৬৩ ॥

tomāre kṣīṇa dekhi, śuni, — kara arddhāśana
You thin I see I hear You make half-eating
ei 'śuṣka-vairāgya' nahe sannyāsīra 'dharma'
this 'dry renunciation' is not a sannyāsī's 'dharma'

63 I see that You have grown thin, and I hear You eat only half Your meals. This dry renunciation is not a sannyāsī's dharma.

In every circumstance perfection is attained only through proper renunciation (yukta-vairāgya) —

যথাযোগ্য উদর ভরে, না করে 'বিষয়' ভোগ ।
সন্ন্যাসীর তবে সিদ্ধ হয় জ্ঞানযোগ ॥ ৬৪ ॥

yathā-yogya udara bhare, nā kare 'viṣaya' bhoga
as is fitting the belly fills not makes 'sense objects' enjoyment
sannyāsīra tabe siddha haya jñāna-yoga
of a sannyāsī then perfected becomes of knowledge yoga

64 When he fills his stomach as is fitting and does not enjoy sense objects, then a sannyāsī's *jñāna-yoga* is perfected.

Everywhere the anarthas are destroyed only by bhakti-yoga joined with proper renunciation — (Bhagavad-gītā, ch. 6, verses 16–17)

নাত্যশ্নতোঽপি যোগোঽস্তি ন চৈকান্তমনশ্নতঃ ।
ন চাতিস্বপ্নশীলস্য জাগ্রতো নৈব চার্জ্জুন ॥ ৬৫ ॥

nāty-aśnato 'pi yogo 'sti
not of one who eats too much even yoga is
na caikāntam anaśnataḥ
not and entirely of one who does not eat
na cāti-svapna-śīlasya
not and too much sleep of one given to
jāgrato naiva cārjuna
of one who keeps awake not indeed and O Arjuna

65 'O Arjuna, there is no yoga for one who eats too much, nor for one who does not eat at all, nor for one given to too much sleep, nor for one who stays awake too long.' (Bhagavad-gītā, 6.16)

Anubhāṣya.
O Arjuna, **atyaśnataḥ** (of one accustomed to eating too much) **tu yogaḥ na asti**, **na ca ekāntam anaśnataḥ** (nor of one intent on eating too little, who does not eat at all), **na ca ati-svapna-śīlasya** (nor of one accustomed to sleeping much), **na ca jāgrataḥ** (nor of one who does not sleep) **eva yogaḥ** (**asti**).

যুক্তাহারবিহারস্য যুক্তচেষ্টস্য কর্ম্মসু ।
যুক্তস্বপ্নাববোধস্য যোগো ভবতি দুঃখহা ॥ ৬৬ ॥

yuktāhāra-vihārasya
of one regulated in eating and recreation
yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu
regulated in effort in actions
yukta-svapnāvabodhasya
regulated in sleep and waking
yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā
yoga becomes of sorrows the destroyer

66 'For one who is regulated in eating and recreation, regulated in his efforts at work, and regulated in sleep and waking, yoga becomes the destroyer of all sorrow.'" (Bhagavad-gītā, 6.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Arjuna, by eating much there is no yoga; by not eating at all there is no yoga either; nor does it come by much sleep or by giving up sleep. But when eating, recreation and all activities — effort, sleep, waking and so on — are kept in proper measure, the yoga that destroys suffering arises.

Anubhāṣya.
yuktāhāra-vihārasya (of one who keeps measure in eating, rest and the like) **karmasu** (in activities, such as the performance of *sādhana*) **yukta-ceṣṭasya** (of one who keeps measure in his undertakings) **yukta-svapnāvabodhasya** (of one firmly keeping measure in sleep and waking) **duḥkha-hā** (ending all suffering) **yogaḥ bhavati**.

The Lord's humble words — the ideal of the dharma of one who seeks no honour (amānī) —

প্রভু কহে, — অজ্ঞ বালক মুই 'শিষ্য' তোমার ।
মোরে শিক্ষা দেহ', — এই ভাগ্য আমার ॥ ৬৭ ॥

prabhu kahe, — ajña bālaka mui 'śiṣya' tomāra
the Lord says ignorant boy I 'disciple' your
more śikṣā deha', — ei bhāgya āmāra
to Me instruction you give this fortune My

67 The Lord said, "I am an ignorant boy, your disciple. That you instruct Me is My good fortune."

He hears that the Lord's devotees eat half —

এত শুনি' রামচন্দ্রপুরী উঠি' গেলা ।
ভক্তগণ অর্দ্ধাশন করে, — গোসাঞি শুনিলা ॥ ৬৮ ॥

eta śuni' rāmacandra-purī uṭhi' gelā
this hearing Rāmacandra Purī getting up went
bhakta-gaṇa arddhāśana kare, — gosāñi śunilā
the devotees half-eating make the Gosāñi heard

68 Hearing this, Rāmacandra Purī got up and left. The Gosāñi heard that the devotees were eating only half their meals.

One day the devotees headed by Paramānanda Purī appeal to the Lord about how much He should eat (literally, "about taking measured food") and censure before Him Rāmacandra Purī's nature and conduct —

আর দিন ভক্তগণ-সহ পরমানন্দপুরী ।
প্রভু-পাশে নিবেদিলা দৈন্য-বিনয় করি' ॥ ৬৯ ॥

āra dina bhakta-gaṇa-saha paramānanda-purī
another day the devotees with Paramānanda Purī
prabhu-pāśe nivedilā dainya-vinaya kari'
to the Lord near submitted humility courtesy making

69 On another day Paramānanda Purī, with the devotees, humbly and courteously submitted to the Lord:

রামচন্দ্রপুরী হয় নিন্দুক-স্বভাব ।
তার বোলে অন্ন ছাড়ি' কিবা হবে লাভ ? ॥ ৭০ ॥

rāmacandra-purī haya ninduka-svabhāva
Rāmacandra Purī is of a fault-finder the nature
tāra bole anna chāḍi' kibā habe lābha?
his at the word food giving up what will be gain

70 "Rāmacandra Purī has the nature of a fault-finder. What will be gained by giving up food at his word?

পুরীর স্বভাব, — যথেষ্ট আহার করাঞা ।
যে না খায়, তারে খাওয়ায় যতন করিয়া ॥ ৭১ ॥

purīra svabhāva, — yatheṣṭa āhāra karāñā
of the Purī the nature as much as one likes food having made eat
ye nā khāya, tāre khāoyāya yatana kariyā
who not eats him he feeds effort making

71 It is the Purī's nature to make people eat as much as they like; and if someone will not eat, he takes great pains to feed him.

খাওয়াঞা পুনঃ তারে করয়ে নিন্দন ।
এত অন্ন খাও, — তোমার কত আছে ধন ? ॥ ৭২ ॥

khāoyāñā punaḥ tāre karaye nindana
having fed then him makes fault-finding
eta anna khāo, — tomāra kata āche dhana?
so much food you eat your how much is there wealth

72 Having fed him, he then finds fault with him: 'You eat so much food — how much wealth do you have?

সন্ন্যাসীকে এত খাওয়াঞা কর ধর্ম্ম নাশ !
অতএব জানিনু, — তোমার কিছু নাহি 'ভাস' ॥ ৭৩ ॥

sannyāsīke eta khāoyāñā kara dharma nāśa!
a sannyāsī so much feeding you make of dharma ruin
ataeva jāninu, — tomāra kichu nāhi 'bhāsa'
therefore I know your any there is not 'semblance'

73 By feeding a sannyāsī so much, you ruin his dharma! Now I see that you have not even a semblance of piety.'[7]

কে কৈছে ব্যবহারে, কেবা কৈছে খায় ।
এই অনুসন্ধান তেঁহো করয় সদায় ॥ ৭৪ ॥

ke kaiche vyavahāre, kebā kaiche khāya
who how in behaviour who how eats
ei anusandhāna temṁho karaya sadāya
this inquiry he makes always

74 He is always inquiring into how each person behaves and how each one eats.

Seeking others' weak points and faults in order to harm them is contrary to scripture and forbidden —

শাস্ত্রে যেই দুই ধর্ম্ম কৈরাছে বর্জ্জন ।
সেই কর্ম্ম নিরন্তর ইঁহার করণ ॥ ৭৫ ॥

śāstre yei dui dharma kairāche varjana
in the scriptures which two duties have made rejection
sei karma nirantara iṁhāra karaṇa
that activity constantly his doing

75 The two things that the scriptures forbid are what he does constantly.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, canto 11, ch. 28, verse 1)

পরস্বভাবকর্ম্মাণি ন প্রশংসেন্ন গর্হয়েৎ ।
বিশ্বমেকাত্মকং পশ্যন্ প্রকৃত্যা পুরুষেণ চ ॥ ৭৬ ॥

para-svabhāva-karmāṇi
of others the nature and actions
na praśaṁsen na garhayet
not one should praise not one should blame
viśvam ekātmakaṁ paśyan
the universe of one nature seeing
prakṛtyā puruṣeṇa ca
with prakṛti with the puruṣa and

76 'One should neither praise nor blame the nature and actions of others, but see the universe as one, a union of prakṛti and the puruṣa.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.28.1)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Seeing the universe as one in nature, as the union of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, one should never praise or blame the nature and deeds of others.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Bhagavān describes to Śrī Uddhava the rules of conduct for a pure *jñānī*:

prakṛtyā puruṣeṇa ca saha ekātmakaṁ viśvaṁ paśyan para-svabhāva-karmāṇi (the nature and deeds of others, that is, their natural occupations and the like, produced by the *guṇas* — [not doing this] in order to harm them) **na praśaṁset**, **na garhayet** (should not blame).

Scripture aims not at the earlier injunction about praise but at the later one, the prohibition of blame —

তার মধ্যে পূর্ব্ববিধি ‘প্রশংসা’ ছাড়িয়া ।
পরবিধি ‘নিন্দা’ করে ‘বলিষ্ঠ’ জানিয়া ॥ ৭৭ ॥

tāra madhye pūrva-vidhi ‘praśaṁsā’ chāḍiyā
of them among the earlier injunction ‘praise’ giving up
para-vidhi ‘nindā’ kare ‘baliṣṭha’ jāniyā
the later injunction ‘blame’ he does ‘stronger’ knowing it

77 Of the two, he gives up the earlier injunction, praise, and practises the later one, blame, knowing that the later one is ‘stronger’.

Anubhāṣya.
In the verse *para-svabhāva…* we find an earlier injunction, “do not praise,” and a later one, “do not blame.” Since the later injunction is stronger than the earlier, it follows that praising people is not such a great fault, but blaming them must never be done. Rāmacandra, however, kept the earlier injunction, “do not praise others,” and did not keep the later one, “do not blame others.” So Rāmacandra did not act according to the rule of the later injunction. The meaning of this verse can be explained as ironic.

The later injunction carries greater weight — (A maxim of nyāya)

পূর্ব্বপরয়োর্মধ্যে পরবিধির্বলবান্ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

pūrva-parayor madhye para-vidhir balavān
of the earlier and later between the later injunction stronger

78 'Between an earlier and a later injunction, the later injunction is stronger.' (a maxim of Nyāya)[9]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Of an earlier and a later injunction, the later is the stronger.

Anubhāṣya.
prāk-parayor vidhyoḥ madhye (of an earlier and a later injunction) **para-vidhiḥ** (the later direction) **balavān** — that is, one should set aside the earlier injunction and accept the later.

Rāmacandra Purī is like a fly —

যাঁহা গুণ শত আছে, তাহা না করে গ্রহণ ।
গুণমধ্যে ছলে করে দোষ-আরোপণ ॥ ৭৯ ॥

yāṁhā guṇa śata āche, tāhā nā kare grahaṇa
where virtues a hundred are those not makes acceptance
guṇa-madhye chale kare doṣa-āropaṇa
virtues among by deceit makes of faults imputation

79 Where there are a hundred virtues he accepts none of them; instead he deceitfully imputes faults to those very virtues.

Rāmacandra's conduct and nature cause the devotees piercing pain —

ইঁহার স্বভাব ইঁহা কহিতে না যুয়ায় ।
তথাপি কহিয়ে কিছু মর্ম্ম-দুঃখ পায় ॥ ৮০ ॥

iṁhāra svabhāva iṁhā kahite nā yuyāya
his nature this to tell not is fitting
tathāpi kahiye kichu marma-duḥkha pāya
still I tell something heart-felt pain receiving

80 It is not fitting even to speak of his nature. Still I tell You something of it, for it pains us to the heart.[10]

Anubhāṣya.
Pāya — "having suffered."

Taking Rāmacandra's words as worthless, they ask the Lord to eat —

ইঁহার বচনে কেনে অন্ন ত্যাগ কর ?
পূর্ব্ববৎ নিমন্ত্রণ মান', — সবার বোল ধর ॥ ৮১ ॥

iṁhāra vacane kene anna tyāga kara?
his at the word why food renunciation You make
pūrvavat nimantraṇa māna', — sabāra bola dhara
as before invitations accept of all the request heed

81 Why do You give up food at his word? Accept invitations as before and heed the request of us all."

The Lord, guru of the world and teacher of people, establishes the rules of the dharma of renunciants. One who equates Īśvara, who is above all rules, with the dependent conditioned jīva is a prākṛta-sahajiyā. And the Lord, though Himself Īśvara, regards Himself as a jīva bound by the rules of renunciation and teaches the ācārya in a renunciant's dress detachment (nairapekṣya) —[13]

প্রভু কহে, — সবে কেনে পুরীরে কর রোষ ?
'সহজ' ধর্ম্ম কহে তেঁহো, তাঁর কিবা দোষ ? ॥ ৮২ ॥

prabhu kahe, — sabe kene purīre kara roṣa?
the Lord says all of you why with the Purī make anger
'sahaja' dharma kahe teṁho, tāṁra kibā doṣa?
'natural' dharma speaks he his what fault

82 The Lord said, "Why are you all angry with the Purī? He speaks the natural dharma of a sannyāsī. What fault is there in him?

যতি হঞা জিহ্বা-লাম্পট্য, — অত্যন্ত অন্যায় ।
যতির ধর্ম্ম, — প্রাণ রাখিতে আহারমাত্র খায় ॥ ৮৩ ॥

yati hañā jihvā-lāmpaṭya, — atyanta anyāya
a renunciant being of the tongue greed very improper
yatira dharma, — prāṇa rākhite āhāra-mātra khāya
a renunciant's dharma life to maintain food only he eats

83 For a renunciant to be greedy of the tongue is very improper. A renunciant's dharma is to eat only as much food as keeps him alive."

At the devotees' insistence the Lord agrees to eat half —

তবে সবে মেলি' প্রভুরে বহু যত্ন কৈলা ।
সবার আগ্রহে প্রভু অর্দ্ধেক রাখিলা ॥ ৮৪ ॥

tabe sabe meli' prabhure bahu yatna kailā
then all together the Lord much entreaty made
sabāra āgrahe prabhu arddheka rākhilā
of all at the insistence the Lord half kept

84 Then all of them together entreated the Lord earnestly, and at everyone's insistence the Lord agreed to take half of His former measure.

দুইপণ কৌড়ি লাগে প্রভুর নিমন্ত্রণে ।
কভু দুইজন ভোক্তা, কভু তিনজনে ॥ ৮৫ ॥

duipaṇa kauḍi lāge prabhura nimantraṇe
two paṇas of cowries is needed the Lord's for the invitation
kabhu dui-jana bhoktā, kabhu tina-jane
sometimes two persons eaters sometimes three persons

85 To invite the Lord now cost two paṇas of cowries. Sometimes two persons ate, sometimes three.

The different ways the Lord took meals in the houses of caste brāhmaṇas who were not devotees and of brāhmaṇas fit to sit in the same row at a meal

(pāṅkteya) —

অভোজ্যান্ন বিপ্র যদি করেন নিমন্ত্রণ ।
প্রসাদ-মূল্য লইতে লাগে কৌড়ি দুইপণ ॥ ৮৬ ॥

abhojyānna vipra yadi karena nimantraṇa
whose cooked food may not be eaten a brāhmaṇa if makes invitation
prasāda-mūlya laite lāge kauḍi duipaṇa
prasāda the price to take is needed cowries two paṇas

86 If a brāhmaṇa whose cooked food could not be accepted invited the Lord, two paṇas of cowries were needed to buy prasāda.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Abhojyānna vipra — a brāhmaṇa in whose house one may not eat the food (*anna*) he cooks.

ভোজ্যান্ন বিপ্র যদি নিমন্ত্রণ করে ।
কিছু 'প্রসাদ' আনে, কিছু পাক করে ঘরে ॥ ৮৭ ॥

bhojyānna vipra yadi nimantraṇa kare
whose cooked food may be eaten a brāhmaṇa if invitation makes
kichu 'prasāda' āne, kichu pāka kare ghare
some 'prasāda' brings some cooking makes at home

87 If a brāhmaṇa whose cooked food could be accepted invited Him, he would bring some prasāda and cook some at home.

Bhagavān, subordinate to His devotees, eats in the houses of Gadādhara, Bhagavān Ācārya and Sārvabhauma —

পণ্ডিত-গোসাঞি, ভগবান্-আচার্য্য, সার্ব্বভৌম ।
নিমন্ত্রণের দিনে যদি করে নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৮৮ ॥

paṇḍita-gosāñi, bhagavān-ācārya, sārvabhauma
Paṇḍita Gosāñi Bhagavān Ācārya Sārvabhauma
nimantraṇera dine yadi kare nimantraṇa
of invitation on the day if make invitation

88 But when Paṇḍita Gosāñi, Bhagavān Ācārya or Sārvabhauma invited Him,

তাঁ-সবার ইচ্ছায় প্রভু করেন ভোজন ।
তাঁহা প্রভুর স্বাতন্ত্র্য নাই, যৈছে তাঁর মন ॥ ৮৯ ॥

tāṁ-sabāra icchāya prabhu karena bhojana
of them all by the wish the Lord takes meal
tāṁhā prabhura svātantrya nāi, yaiche tāṁra mana
there the Lord's independence is not as their mind

89 the Lord ate as they wished. In their homes He had no independence: all was as they desired.

The purpose of the Lord's descent and the way He acts —

ভক্তগণে সুখ দিতে প্রভুর 'অবতার' ।
যাঁহা যৈছে যোগ্য, তাঁহা করেন ব্যবহার ॥ ৯০ ॥

bhakta-gaṇe sukha dite prabhura 'avatāra'
to the devotees happiness to give the Lord's 'descent'
yāṁhā yaiche yogya, tāṁhā karena vyavahāra
where how fitting there He makes conduct

90 The Lord descended to give happiness to His devotees, and He acted as was fitting in each place and situation.

Sometimes the Lord behaves like a worldly jīva and thereby deceives; sometimes, as the Supreme Lord, He bestows full mercy —

কভু লৌকিক রীতি, — যেন 'ইতর' জন ।
কভু স্বতন্ত্র, করেন 'ঐশ্বর্য্য' প্রকটন ॥ ৯১ ॥

kabhu laukika rīti, — yena 'itara' jana
sometimes worldly ways as if 'ordinary' person
kabhu svatantra, karena 'aiśvarya' prakaṭana
sometimes independent makes 'divine majesty' manifestation

91 Sometimes He followed worldly ways, like an ordinary person; sometimes, being independent, He displayed His divine majesty (*aiśvarya*).

Sometimes He gives Rāmacandra Purī worldly respect, sometimes He disregards him like a straw —

কভু রামচন্দ্রপুরীর হয় ভৃত্যপ্রায় ।
কভু তারে নাহি মানে, দেখে তৃণ-প্রায় ॥ ৯২ ॥

kabhu rāmacandra-purīra haya bhṛtya-prāya
sometimes of Rāmacandra Purī is a servant almost
kabhu tāre nāhi māne, dekhe tṛṇa-prāya
sometimes him not regards sees a straw like

92 Sometimes He was almost like a servant of Rāmacandra Purī; sometimes He paid him no regard and looked on him as a straw.

All the conduct of the inconceivable Īśvara is eternal, auspicious and beautiful —

ঈশ্বর-চরিত্র প্রভুর — বুদ্ধির অগোচর ।
যবে যেই করেন, সেই সব — মনোহর ॥ ৯৩ ॥

īśvara-caritra prabhura — buddhira agocara
divine conduct of the Lord of the intellect beyond the reach
yabe yei karena, sei saba — manohara
when whatever He does that all enchanting

93 The Lord's divine conduct is beyond the reach of the intellect. Whatever He does, at whatever time, is wholly enchanting.

Abandoning the shelter of Bhagavān, Rāmacandra goes on pilgrimage —

এইমত রামচন্দ্রপুরী নীলাচলে ।
দিন কত রহি' গেলা 'তীর্থ' করিবারে ॥ ৯৪ ॥

ei-mata rāmacandra-purī nīlācale
in this way Rāmacandra Purī in Nīlācala
dina kata rahi' gelā 'tīrtha' karibāre
days some staying went 'pilgrimage' to make

94 In this way Rāmacandra Purī stayed some days in Nīlācala and then left on pilgrimage.

The devotees' hearts are relieved, and they breathe freely again —

তেঁহো গেলে প্রভুর গণ হৈল হরষিত ।
শিরের পাথর যেন পড়িল আচম্বিত ॥ ৯৫ ॥

teṁho gele prabhura gaṇa haila haraṣita
he when gone the Lord's associates became delighted
śirera pāthara yena paḍila ācambita
from the head a stone as if fell suddenly

95 When he had gone, the Lord's associates were delighted, as if a stone had suddenly fallen from their heads.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śirera pāthara — just as one feels light when a heavy stone suddenly falls from one's head, so it happened.

Thus ends the eighth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Giving up the worldly rules of dry renunciation, the devotees, whose life is Gaura, please the Lord with their whole being —

স্বচ্ছন্দে নিমন্ত্রণ, প্রভুর কীর্ত্তন-নর্ত্তন ।
স্বচ্ছন্দে করেন সবে প্রসাদ ভোজন ॥ ৯৬ ॥

svacchande nimantraṇa, prabhura kīrtana-nartana
freely invitations the Lord's kīrtana dancing
svacchande karena sabe prasāda bhojana
freely make all prasāda eating

96 Freely the Lord again accepted invitations and freely He sang kīrtana and danced; freely everyone again ate prasāda.

When a guru rejects a jīva for disrespect, the result is hostility to Viṣṇu, that is, godlessness (pāṣaṇḍatā) —

গুরু উপেক্ষা কৈলে, ঐছে ফল হয় ।
ক্রমে ঈশ্বরপর্য্যন্ত অপরাধে ঠেকয় ॥ ৯৭ ॥

guru upekṣā kaile, aiche phala haya
the guru disregard if he makes such result is
krame īśvara-paryanta aparādhe ṭhekaya
gradually the Lord even up to in offences one becomes caught

97 When the guru disregards someone, such is the result: gradually he comes to offend even the Lord.

Through the conduct of the offender Rāmacandra the Lord teaches the world —

যদ্যপি গুরুবুদ্ধ্যে প্রভু তার দোষ না লইল ।
তার ফলদ্বারা লোকে শিক্ষা করাইল ॥ ৯৮ ॥

yadyapi guru-buddhye prabhu tāra doṣa nā laila
although as a guru regarding him the Lord his fault not took
tāra phala-dvārā loke śikṣā karāila
of it the fruit by means of the people teaching gave

98 Regarding him as a guru, the Lord did not hold his faults against him; yet through the fruit they bore He taught the people.

For one who drinks the Caitanya-caritāmṛta with the cups of the ears, it becomes an elixir for heart and ears —

চৈতন্যচরিত্র — যেন অমৃতের পূর ।
শুনিতে শ্রবণে মনে লাগয়ে মধুর ॥ ৯৯ ॥

caitanya-caritra — yena amṛtera pūra
Caitanya's conduct like of nectar a flood
śunite śravaṇe mane lāgaye madhura
in hearing to the ears to the mind feels sweet

99 Śrī Caitanya's conduct is like a flood of nectar; when heard, it is sweet to the ears and to the mind.

Simply by hearing of Caitanya's deeds one attains love for Kṛṣṇa —

চৈতন্যচরিত্র লিখি, শুন একমনে ।
অনায়াসে পাবে প্রেম শ্রীকৃষ্ণচরণে ॥ ১০০ ॥

caitanya-caritra likhi, śuna eka-mane
Caitanya's conduct I write hear with one mind
anāyāse pābe prema śrī-kṛṣṇa-caraṇe
easily you will attain love of Śrī Kṛṣṇa at the feet

100 I write of Śrī Caitanya's conduct: hear it with undivided attention, and you will easily attain love for the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the eighth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১০১ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

101 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[11]

Notes

1. The first line is the same as Ādi 8.4; translated as there. ↩
2. Śrī Īśvara Purī is the Guru of Mahāprabhu. ↩
3. The same verse as Madhya 4.197; translated as there. Here it is spoken by Mādhavendra Purī himself. The source follows the heading in the edition of this chapter: "the words of Mādhavendra Purī, given in the *Padyāvalī* as number

330” (the heading to Madhya 4.197 gives number 400); the *Anubhāṣya* refers to Madhya 4.197. ↩

4. A paṇa is eighty cowries. ↩
5. *Aikṣava* — molasses from sugarcane (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). ↩
6. The Lord ate half of the appointed quarter-pot, and Govinda the rest (57). ↩
7. *Bhāsa* — “a semblance, a shadow” ↩
8. *Ekātmakam* — “one in nature” ↩
9. The source follows the heading in the edition: “a maxim of Nyāya” (*nyāya-vacana*). ↩
10. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *iṅhā kahite*, “to speak of this” (another reading: *iṅhā karite*, “to act so”). ↩
11. The colophon verse is the same as Antya 2.172; translated as there. ↩
12. In the verse translation, otherwise: “This offence against his teacher awakened many worldly desires in Rāmacandra Purī”; for the commentator, *vāsanā* is the desire for dry knowledge. ↩
13. It is not clear from the text who this ācārya in a renunciant’s dress is; from the course of the story, probably Paramānanda Purī, who together with the devotees appeals to the Lord (vv. 69–81). Another reading is also possible: the “ācārya in a renunciant’s dress” is the Lord Himself, who, accepting the reproach, thereby teaches others (cf. subheadings 50 and 61). ↩